MZ2POL-14: Zone Disposition Workshop

> **Series:** MZ2POL — Management Zone to Policy Migration | **Notebook:** Bonus Workshop | **Created:** October 2026 | **Last Updated:** 10/13/2026

Overview

A management-zone migration stalls on decisions, not on configuration. Somebody has to say which zones die, which job each surviving zone does, what the team and stage values are, who sets them, and what each group may see. This workshop is a structured way to get those decisions made by the people who own them, in one series of working sessions, with every decision written into a table the build work can use.

> **Workshop Format:** a hands-on planning exercise that turns MZ2POL-00 and -03 output into the inputs MZ2POL-10, -11, -12, -05 and -09 need. It does not build anything. MZ2POL-95 LAB is the worked example: the same sessions applied to a fictional eight-zone estate.

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Prerequisites

Requirement	Details
Inputs	MZ2POL-00 rule export; the classified inventory from MZ2POL-03; IdP group list; alerting profile list
Reading for the facilitator	MZ2POL-10, -11, -12 — the workshop asks the questions those notebooks answer
Tenant access	`storage:entities:read` for the two pre-work queries (zero bytes scanned)
Time	In community practice, one long day for a few dozen zones; split sessions 4–6 across days for large estates

1. Who Should Attend

Role	Why they are needed	Decides
Observability platform owner (facilitator)	Knows the zone estate and the target model	Running order, stop conditions
IAM / identity owner	Owns IdP groups and the account	Group design, who binds what
One owner per application team	Knows what the zone was actually for	Keep / delete, job, team value
Infrastructure / Kubernetes owner	Controls host tags, OneAgent install, namespaces	Where values are set, by whom
On-call / incident lead	Owns alerting profiles and destinations	Routing replacements, parity window
Security or compliance (for P1 zones)	Signs off restricted data	Boundary values for regulated data

A team that does not send an owner cannot have its zones decided. Park them — do not guess.

2. Before the Workshop

Run these two queries and bring the output. Both read the classic entity model, scan zero bytes, and were executed on the validation tenant on 10/13/2026.

Pre-work A — which tag keys do the zones rely on? (MZ2POL-10 §9, Step 2)

```
// Classic tag keys on hosts: the vocabulary the zones were built from. Zero bytes scanned.
fetch dt.entity.host
| fields entity.name, tags
| expand tags
| parse tags, "LD:tag_key ':' LD"
| fieldsAdd tag_key = coalesce(tag_key, tags)
| summarize {hosts = countDistinctExact(entity.name)}, by:{tag_key}
| sort hosts desc
| limit 50
```

Pre-work B — which zones are really host-group zones? (MZ2POL-11 §9, Check 1)

```
// Per zone: how many host groups its hosts span, and how many hosts have none. Zero bytes scanned.
fetch dt.entity.host
| fields entity.name, managementZones, hostGroupName
| expand managementZones
| filter isNotNull(managementZones)
| summarize {hosts = count(),
    without_host_group = countIf(isNull(hostGroupName)),
    host_groups = countDistinct(hostGroupName),
    group_list = collectDistinct(hostGroupName)},
    by:{zone = managementZones}
| fieldsAdd translation = if(without_host_group &gt; 0, "needs a tag - some hosts have no host group",
    else: if(host_groups == 1, "dt.host_group.id = &lt;group&gt;",
    else: if(host_groups &lt;= 5, "in(dt.host_group.id, {...})",
    else: "needs a tag - spans many host groups")))
| sort hosts desc
| limit 100
```

Also bring, as exports or screenshots:

- **Role assignments per zone** — which groups hold which classic roles on which zones (the access job).
- **Alerting profiles** with their zone filters and destinations (the alerting job).
- **Dashboard and query usage per zone** for the last 90 days (the filtering job — and the "unused" evidence for deletion).

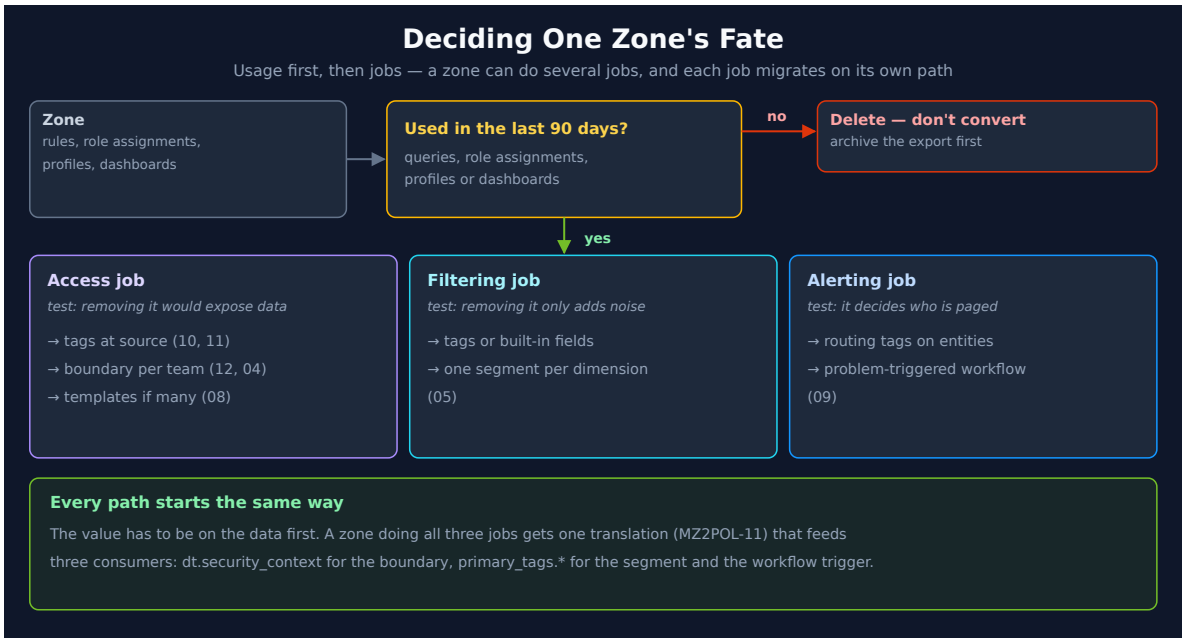
3. The Six Sessions



Every session ends with its table filled in. If it cannot be, the open items go on the stop list and the session after it works only on the zones that are complete.

4. Session 1 — Triage

Question: does this zone still do anything?



Zone	Owner	Used in 90 days? (evidence)	Decision
		queries / roles / profiles / dashboards	keep / delete / park

Delete aggressively. A zone nobody uses is a zone nobody needs translated, tagged, tested or explained. MZ2POL-05 §2 makes the same point for filtering zones.

5. Session 2 — Jobs

Question: for each kept zone, which of the three jobs does it do? A zone can do more than one, and each job migrates separately.

Zone	Access?	Filtering?	Alerting?	Priority (MZ2POL-03)	Notes
	removing it exposes data	removing it adds noise	it decides who is paged	P1 – P3	

Use the series' test word for word: *if removing it would let someone see data they must not, it is access; if it would only make dashboards noisy, it is filtering; if it decides who is paged, it is alerting.* Teams routinely overestimate the access share — most estates are mostly filtering (MZ2POL-05 §1).

6. Session 3 — Dimensions and Tags

Question: what are the few dimensions behind all these zones, and what are their allowed values?

Dimension	Key	Allowed values	Constrained?	Also written to `dt.security_context`?	Set by (producer, owner)
Team	`primary_tags.team`	payments, checkout, …	yes — allowlist	yes, as `<stage>/<team>`	central rule / DT_TAGS / namespace annotation
Stage	`primary_tags.stage`	prod, staging, dev	yes	inside the context value	host group or install
App	`primary_tags.app`		open	no	deployment pipeline

Rules the session enforces (MZ2POL-10 §4–§8):

- **Follow the vocabulary you already have** — cloud tags, Kubernetes labels, the CMDB.
- **Constrain** stage, region and classification; agree spellings now (Grail compares exactly).
- **Write access dimensions to `dt.security_context` too** — a primary tag cannot carry IAM.
- **Stay well under 20 primary tags per host or process.**
- **Name an owner for every producer**, including the ones that inherit nothing: remote extensions, synthetic monitors, RUM, API ingest (FAQ-26 §5).

7. Session 4 — Rule Translation

Question: where does each rule's logic live now?

Fill one worksheet row per **rule**, not per zone — the format is MZ2POL-11 §10. Walk the decision path in order: built-in field → set at source → central enrichment rule → OpenPipeline tag rule → explicit membership tag.

Zone	Rule #	Property · operator · value	Decision step	Target field = value	Set where, by whom
			1–5		

Call out, as each appears:

- **Exclusions** (`NOT_*`) — push the `NOT` into the enrichment condition; segments and record-level IAM cannot exclude (MZ2POL-11 §5).
- **Regex, numeric, IP-range** — no Grail surface evaluates them; the value must be computed at the source.
- **Propagation flags** — decide where the value is really true (host or process), instead of copying the flag (MZ2POL-10 §7).
- **Entity selectors with relationships** — list-type zones go to Smartscape queries; data-scope zones need a tag (MZ2POL-11 §7).

8. Session 5 — Personas and Boundaries

Question: which groups exist, what may each read and change, and which boundary scopes it?

IdP group	Persona	Policies (defaults first)	Boundary	Boundary lines — one per domain the policies grant
	developer / lead / SRE / auditor			`storage:dt.security_context MATCH (…)` ; `settings:dt.security_context IN (…)` ; `environment:management-zone IN (…)` while classic pages are used

The facilitator checks every row against MZ2POL-12 before the session closes:

- **Every domain covered.** A zone-only boundary on a default policy leaves Grail unscoped; a Grail-only boundary on Standard User leaves classic pages unscoped (MZ2POL-12 §4.2).
- **One boundary per binding** for team scope; shared data as an extra value on the same condition, not a second boundary (MZ2POL-12 §4.1).
- **No unscoped data policy** in any group a team member also belongs to (§3).
- **`MATCH`** on `storage:dt.security_context` wherever events are in scope.
- **Settings** scoped by edge-set security context or `settings:schemaId` — not by zones (§5).

9. Session 6 — Alerting and Cutover

Question: what replaces each alerting profile, and in what order do zones leave?

Routing table (MZ2POL-09):

Alerting profile	Zone	Replacement workflow	Trigger tag / DQL matcher	Minimum duration (from delay)	Destination	Parity window

Batch plan (MZ2POL-06 §6 states):

Batch	Zones	Exit evidence for "verified"	Rollback line	Owner
	P1 first	tag gate green; effective permissions clean; alert parity	re-add the zone line / re-enable the profile	

Two sequencing rules are not negotiable: alerting profiles are **disabled** before anything is deleted, and **zones are deleted last**, in a separate change window (MZ2POL-09 §8).

10. Facilitator Notes: Traps to Name Out Loud

Each of these has cost real migrations time, and each looks correct on paper. Say them before the session where they apply.

Session	Trap	Why it bites
1	"Keep it, just in case"	Every kept zone costs a translation, a tag, a test and a cutover step
2	Treating filtering zones as access	Turns a segment into an IAM project
3	A tag key with no allowed values	`prod`, `Prod` and `production` become three segment values
3	"We'll tag it in OpenPipeline later"	A backstop rule overwrites source values unless guarded with `isNull`
4	Copying `pgToHost` propagation	Puts a shared host's metrics in front of one team
5	Re-creating zones as zone-only boundaries	Grail is unscoped — every default data policy reads everything
5	Adding a second boundary for shared data	Boundaries are computed separately; a permission one cannot scope leaks
5	Testing access as an admin	Admin grants hide every boundary problem
6	Deleting zones and disabling profiles together	No way to tell which caused a regression

Session	Trap	Why it bites
Any	"Wait for Spaces"	Not documented as available; build on documented mechanisms (MZ2POL-13)

11. Outputs and Next Steps

Output	Feeds
Triage table (keep / delete)	Deletion list; MZ2POL-03 inventory
Jobs table	Which of MZ2POL-12/04, -05, -09 each zone goes to
Dimension and tag table	MZ2POL-10 enrichment work and its readiness gate
Rule worksheet	MZ2POL-11 §10; the record kept until each zone is retired
Persona and boundary table	MZ2POL-12 design; MZ2POL-08 templates if teams are many
Routing table and batch plan	MZ2POL-09 workflows; MZ2POL-06 execution
Stop list	The next workshop's agenda

The build starts with the tag work — nothing else can be tested until the MZ2POL-10 gate passes.

Summary

1. **Decisions, not configuration** — the workshop exists to get owners to decide.
2. **Six sessions, six tables**; each table is the next session's input.
3. **Triage hard**: delete unused zones before translating anything.
4. **One translation per rule** feeds the boundary, the segment and the workflow.
5. **Name the traps** before the session where they apply.

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